

WEEK 2 LESSON GUIDE

WONDER

BIG IDEA

We worship because God provides.

BIBLE

Psalm 111; Luke 12:24–32;
Philippians 4:19

ABOUT THIS WEEK

Along the edges of a breathtaking canyon, birds gather food for their young, reminding us that every detail of creation is taken care of—and we're no different. This week, we'll see how God meets our needs that are easy to notice and the needs we can't see. Understanding how much we're cared for inspires us to respond in praise, so **we worship because God provides.**

WHAT? What are we talking about?



See the
Accessibility Hacks



IMAGE | The Grand Canyon

- For the next few weeks, we're exploring what worship means and how we can worship God with our words and our lives. This week, we'll take a look at a different natural wonder—the Grand Canyon.
- **INSTRUCTIONS:** As you teach, show an image of the Grand Canyon like [this one](#) from Unsplash. These images are free for you to use under the [Unsplash license](#). [Read this](#) for more information on legally using copyrighted material for educational purposes!
- If you've never seen it, this is the Grand Canyon. It's a huge, 277-mile-long canyon in Arizona. One feature is the Skywalk, a little horseshoe-shaped bridge with a glass floor. You can look down and see the Colorado River at the base of the canyon, which is about 4,000 feet below the Skywalk.
- The Grand Canyon is pretty incredible, huh? Have you ever wondered what it'd be like to live in it? You'd probably have to ask yourself...
 - Would I have everything I needed?
 - What would I do if it rained?
 - Where would I find food?
 - Would I be safe?
- Wow. What started as a fun thought turned into a reality check. The idea of standing inside such an immense structure can quickly make us reflect on our own needs and safety.

DISCUSSION

- **INSTRUCTIONS:** If you have more than 15 students, skip this discussion and save it for small groups. If you conduct this discussion, the starred questions are designed for high schoolers, so you may want to skip them for middle schoolers.



See the High
School Hacks



- What's one place in nature you've visited that you'd recommend to others?
- *If there was only one item you could take with you on a long hike, what would it be?

ACTIVITY | Canyon Camp Chaos (Part One)

- If you're going to experience a wonder like the Grand Canyon, you'll need to have everything ready to go. There's no place to shop for food or buy water, so you'll need to think ahead to pack what's needed for your trip. Because if you run out of food... yikes. But with the right preparation—and the right group of people—you'll have what you need.
- **INSTRUCTIONS:** Before the activity, hide basecamp essentials (water bottle, rope, tent poles, hiking boots, lantern, and first aid kit) around the room. Split students into six teams to find the items. Each team goes out to find an item and returns to their seats once they find one. The activity continues until all teams have located a hiking item.
- One of the biggest rules about hiking in a place like the Grand Canyon is to never go alone. You'll always want at least one person with you to help when you need it. You could get injured or could just need a friend to lift your spirits when you're feeling tired. Of course, you should *definitely* pack well and be prepared, but having a friend with you can help you face the unexpected.



See the Hacks



QUESTION | When did someone provide for you?

- Speaking of help, it's not just for hikes in the Grand Canyon but also for our daily lives. We need people to help us every once in a while. Think about your life. When have you needed help from someone else?
- **INSTRUCTIONS:** Ask the following questions and give a few students an opportunity to respond.
 - **When was a time someone provided for you?**
 - **How did that make you feel?**
- It's so inspiring to hear stories of how the people in our lives show up to help us when we need it. I think my favorite part is that feeling you get, that big sigh of relief we let out when we realize we don't need to carry our burdens all by ourselves.
- But why is it so hard for us to admit we need help? Maybe...
 - You feel embarrassed.
 - You think, "I shouldn't need help. I should be able to do this on my own."
 - You're worried about what others might think of you if you admit you need help.
 - You don't know who you can turn to for help.
- Whether we're hiking through the Grand Canyon, trying to overcome a fear of looking down on the Skywalk, or just going about our everyday lives, we all need help sometimes. We can't do everything on our own, and that's okay! Noticing who God puts in our lives at the right moment is a chance to respond with worship.

SO WHAT? Why does it matter to God and to us?

See the High
School Hacks

**SCRIPTURE | Psalm 111**

- Last week, we looked at the Psalms and how they help us understand worship. Inside the book of Psalms, the authors were filled with wonder and awe about God as they responded to their very human experiences.
- The psalmists wrote about what they were feeling, thinking, and hoping for during their life ups and downs. These poems and songs help us see how we can worship in different ways. Let's take a look at one of them.
- **INSTRUCTIONS:** Read Psalm 111.
- The author of this psalm praises God for providing food and a home to people who need it. But instead of only providing for people's physical needs, God also provides grace, compassion, and redemption to the people who follow God.
- Remember, worship is a response to an experience, and this psalm shows us what that can look like. God took care of this writer's physical and spiritual needs, and they responded with worship.
- Now, it's a lot easier for us to notice when someone is providing for our physical needs. We can see it, hold it, or experience it. But God goes above and beyond and provides for our spiritual needs, too—sometimes, we're not even aware of it!
- When we need help in our lives, this psalm helps remind us of how God provides, whether we see it or not. This psalm shows how God provides for people. It helps set the pattern for how God will continue to provide in the future and lets us know we'll be safe when we let God take care of us. Plus, it points us to respond in a great way—with worship!

DISCUSSION

- **INSTRUCTIONS:** If you have more than 15 students, skip this discussion and save it for small groups. If you conduct this discussion, the starred questions are designed for high schoolers, so you may want to skip them for middle schoolers.
 - **What are some ways you have provided for someone else?**
 - ***When was a time you worshiped as a result of an experience, like the writer in Psalm 111?**



Share your story

**STORY | A Time When God Provided For You**

- It can be hard to know when God provides for you—it's not always easy to see right away. Sometimes, we need more time to look back and reflect on our lives. Let me tell you about one of those moments in my life.
- **INSTRUCTIONS:** Tell a story about a time you realized God provided for you. What happened? How did you see God's provision in that moment? When did you realize God was the one who provided for you? You can also invite a volunteer to share their experience.
- Some of you might hear that story and think, "That's great for you, but God's never shown up for me." Even if we're looking pretty hard, it can be difficult to see how God provides, especially in painful situations.
- We don't know when the psalm we read earlier was written. It could've been five

minutes after the author's experience or five years later. We don't even know the full details of what happened. But we do know that someone recognized God's movement, protection, and provision in their life.

- So, you might not see it right now or tomorrow—but even if you don't see it right away, you can know that God is showing up and providing for you. Just like the psalmist, you can worship in response.

SCRIPTURE | Luke 12:24–32

- One day, when Jesus was teaching his followers, he used real-world examples to show them how God would take care of them. Let's read about that now.
- **INSTRUCTIONS:** Read Luke 12:24–32.
- It's easy for us to worry about what will come next. Even when Jesus was teaching on earth, people wondered if God would take care of them. Here, Jesus told them directly, "God will take care of you!" If the plants and animals have everything they need, don't you think God will give you what you need, too? That doesn't mean you'll have the best clothes, the most food in your pantry, or the nicest car. Just like in Psalm 111, Jesus moves beyond our physical needs and helps meet our spiritual needs, too.
- God doesn't just provide for our surface needs. God moves layers deeper than we can imagine and provides us with what we *really* need. God gives us what we can't provide for ourselves, like grace, hope, and redemption.
- In those moments, we're invited to see the bigger picture. God has created experiences for us that we could never develop on our own. God's care for us is so vast and beyond our imagination that it can feel like... well, like seeing the Grand Canyon for the first time.
- Once we see it, we'll never be the same. Full of awe and wonder, we'll be compelled to worship in response to what God has done for all of us.
- We don't have to worry because we know God will provide. We don't have to panic because we know God will take care of us. No matter what, we can worship in response.

DISCUSSION

- **INSTRUCTIONS:** If you have more than 15 students, skip this discussion and save it for small groups. If you conduct this discussion, the starred questions are designed for high schoolers, so you may want to skip them for middle schoolers.
 - ***How difficult is it for you to live a life free of worry like Jesus talked about? Why?**
 - **Read Philippians 4:19. How have you experienced God meeting your needs in your own life?**



Use your Gifts



OBJECT LESSON | Canyon Camp Chaos (Part Two)

- **INSTRUCTIONS:** For this activity, you will need the items from Part One (a water bottle, rope, hiking boots, tent poles, first aid kit, and compass) and place all of them inside a backpack. As you talk about each item, remove it from the bag and place it on a table for your group to see.

- Remember those items from earlier? You searched around the room for everything you needed for a Grand Canyon hike. Well, those weren't random items. They all help remind us of the ways God provides for us.
 - **The bottle of water represents our basic needs.** God provides the most basic needs for us to survive.
 - **The rope represents our relationships.** God provides people who can keep us connected to God for safety or to help us grow.
 - **The hiking boots represent wisdom.** There are people in your life who have rich experiences and have learned a lot from them. God gives us these people to help us grow as we follow Jesus.
 - **The tent poles and tent represent shelter.** God provides more than just physical shelter. God made a home for each of us, and we're invited to be part of God's family.
 - **The first aid kit represents redemption.** Through Jesus, God provides a way for us all to be restored and have our relationship with God fixed. We'll talk about this more at a different time, but God does more than just patch us up—God heals us.
 - **The compass represents direction.** When we're not sure where to go, we can look to God for guidance. In Scripture, we have God's words to help us live a life aligned with God's plans for the world. We don't have to wander off on our own or try to figure it out alone.
- Do you see it? When we make the slightest shift in our perspective, we can see all the different ways God chooses to provide for us. And it's not just for one person, but for everyone willing to see and accept it!
- God has given us so much, which is so inspiring. We're not meant to figure life out on our own—we need help. God took the first step to offer that help to us. That's what the psalmist experienced. That's what Jesus hoped his followers could see. It's what's happening in front of you right now.
- God is taking action to take care of you at this very moment and reaching out to show you that you'll be okay. You might still struggle, wonder, or have questions, but God has already provided for you. Now, you get to respond. **We worship because God provides.**

NOW WHAT? What does God want us to do about it?



Spend Time
with others



OBJECT LESSON | Remember Rocks

- We experience so much every day, and it's no surprise that remembering to worship is a challenge. Let's explore a tradition that will help us remember the ways God takes care of us.
- In Scripture, there are stories of people who used rocks and stones to build visual reminders of God's work in their lives. Every time the people passed these stones, they reflected on the past provision.
- **INSTRUCTIONS:** *For this object lesson, you'll need several loose rocks. As you talk, begin stacking the rocks to build a cairn like [this one](#).*
- This is called a cairn. Cairns are monuments that help guide hikers so they stay on a trail. The stacked rocks remind them of the path they need to keep on and point

them toward the end of the trail. This is a great way for us to think about worship a little differently. See, we all have a chance to build these cairns to help us...

- **REMEMBER WHAT GOD HAS DONE:** How often do you take time to just *remember*? It's probably not a normal part of your life. When hikers make these cairns, they're setting aside time to think about where they've been and where they need to go. They're thinking about the trail ahead and when they might need a reminder to keep going or to guide them on the right path. Every time you reflect on how God has provided for you, that's an act of worship.
- **TRUST IN WHAT GOD CAN DO:** When you remember how God has provided for you, you'll have the energy and motivation you need to keep going. By looking to the past, you can see a new vision for the future as you lean into what God can do in your life and the lives of those around you. Our worship isn't just about looking back but about looking ahead—with our full trust in how God will provide.
- Monuments like these carry deep meaning that can help us connect with God and remind us of what God is doing. They push us to remember and respond to God and help us worship as we recognize the ways God provides for us.



See the Hacks



RESPONSE | Write To Remember

- **INSTRUCTIONS:** For this response, you will need a small box, [smooth rocks](#), and permanent markers. Before your program, set up a box of small, smooth pond rocks near your cairn object lesson. Using permanent markers, ask your group to write ways that God has provided for them in the past. They can also use this time to pray and ask God for help.
- I want to give you all a chance to start this process of remembering what God has done and trusting what God will do in the future. We have a few small rocks and some markers here. Take a rock and marker, then write down something you're worried about. It could be a situation you're struggling with, an unmet need, or something else you want God's help with. Write down what's on your mind and place your rock on the cairn.
- Then, once you've placed your rock down, take another rock from the pile and pray for that need. Ask for wisdom, for help, or for increased trust as this person counts the ways God has provided for them.

DISCUSSION

- **INSTRUCTIONS:** If you have more than 15 students, skip this discussion and save it for small groups. If you conduct this discussion, the starred questions are designed for high schoolers, so you may want to skip them for middle schoolers.
 - ***What's one distraction that keeps you from seeing where God is working? What would it look like for you to focus on God rather than your distractions today?**
 - **Who's someone you look up to because of the ways they worship God? What's one thing they do that you could implement into your life this week?**



See the
Accessibility Hacks



Spend Time
With God



- This week, what's one way you can be more intentional about worshiping because God provides?

MUSIC | "Jireh" (Maverick City Music)

- God has taken care of us and provided for us in so many ways. Sometimes, we need a little help remembering that. Whether it's through poems and songs like Psalm 111, reminders of Jesus' teaching, or cairns and monuments that reflect our experiences, we can remember that God moves in our lives.
- **INSTRUCTIONS:** Invite students to worship by remembering and thanking God for the ways they have been provided for as you play the song "Jireh" (Maverick City Music). Make sure you have purchased any licenses required to do so. [Read this](#) for more information on legally using copyrighted material for educational purposes! Here's [a link](#) to preview the song for your personal use.
- I hope you've seen how God provides for you and feel inspired this week to remember that the same God who carved out something as massive and wonderful as the Grand Canyon is still close enough to take care of you. Remember, **we worship because God provides.**